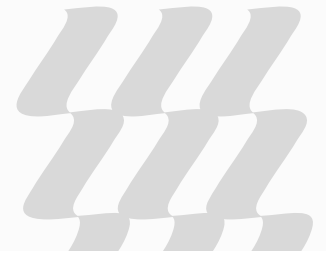
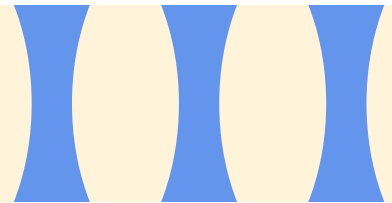


GCSE English Language Paper 2 Guide: Made for ESL Students



Welcome to Your Paper 2 ESL Guide!



Purpose of this Guide

This guide is made for students who are learning English as a second language (ESL) and are preparing for the **GCSE AQA English Language Paper 2** exam.

We know that English exams can be confusing, especially when English is not your first language. That's why this guide explains everything in **simple, easy-to-understand steps**, with lots of **examples, tips, and practice**.

Our goal is to help you feel **confident, prepared, and ready to do your best**.

What is Paper 2?

English Language Paper 2 tests your reading and writing skills. You will:

- **Read two non-fiction texts** (like letters, articles, or speeches)
- **Answer four reading questions**
- **Write your own non-fiction text**, like a letter, article, or speech

You will be tested on how well you:

- **Understand information**
- **Compare ideas**
- **Explain clearly**

- Use language and structure effectively

The exam is 1 hour and 45 minutes long.

Who is This Guide For?

This guide is for:

- ESL students in the UK
- Students who want clear explanations
- Learners who need extra help with reading, writing, and vocabulary

No matter your level, this guide is for you.

- ✓ We use **simple English**
- ✓ We explain every question **step-by-step**
- ✓ We show you **what examiners want**
- ✓ We help you **avoid common mistakes**

You can do this — and we're here to help!

What's in This Guide?

Here's what you'll find in each section:

-  **Reading Questions (Q1–Q4)**
Learn how to read texts, find answers, and explain clearly
-  **Writing Task (Q5)**
Learn how to plan, write, and improve your non-fiction writing
-  **ESL Tips and Help**
Vocabulary, grammar, and exam advice for ESL students
-  **Practice and Model Answers**
Try practice questions and read high-quality sample answers

Paper 2 Overview

What Is This Exam About?

In Paper 2, you will read **two non-fiction texts** (like articles, letters, or speeches). You will answer **four reading questions** and then do **one writing task**.

This paper checks how well you can:

- Understand and **summarise** information
- **Compare** ideas between two texts
- **Explain** how writers use language and structure
- Write your **own non-fiction text**

You have **1 hour and 45 minutes** to complete the exam.

Reading Section (Q1–Q4)

You will read **two different texts** from different times or places. Then answer these questions:

Question	What it asks	Marks	Skills Tested
Q1	Choose 4 true statements	4 marks	Understanding information
Q2	Summarise the differences or similarities	8 marks	Summary + inference
Q3	Analyse the writer's use of language	12 marks	Language analysis
Q4	Compare the writers' ideas + methods	16 marks	Comparison + evaluation

Writing Section (Q5)

You will write a **non-fiction text** (letter, article, speech, etc.) based on a topic or issue.

You need to:

- **Plan** your response
- **Use paragraphs** clearly
- Use **persuasive or informative language**
- Show a strong **tone and purpose**

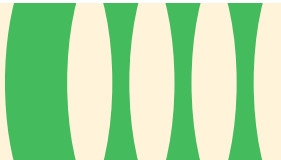
Marks: 40 (24 marks for content, 16 marks for spelling/grammar)

 Use your time wisely!

Here is a guide to help you plan:

Tasks To Complete During Your Exam	Suggested Time
Reading & annotating both texts	10 minutes
Q1 – 4 marks	5 minutes
Q2 – 8 marks	10 minutes
Q3 – 12 marks	12–15 minutes
Q4 – 16 marks	20 minutes
Q5 – 40 marks	40–45 minutes
Final check	5 minutes

Tip: The writing task is worth the most, so leave time for it!



Section 1: Reading (Q1 – Q4)



Before we start Section 1, it's important to understand the key techniques writers use. This section explains the most common language and structure devices, their definitions, simple examples, and the effects they have on the reader.

Language Devices

✓ Noun

- **Definition:** A word that names a person, place, thing, or idea.
- **Examples:**
 - *Teacher* (person)
 - *London* (place)
 - *Dog* (thing)
 - *Freedom* (idea)
- **Effect:** Helps the reader know what or who the sentence is about.

✓ Verb

- **Definition:** A word that shows an action or a state of being.
- **Examples:**
 - *Run* (action)
 - *Think* (mental action)
 - *Is* (state of being)
- **Effect:** Brings action, movement, or existence into the sentence.

✓ Adjective

- **Definition:** A word that describes a noun (adds detail).
- **Examples:**
 - *Blue sky*
 - *Happy child*
 - *Cold night*
- **Effect:** Helps the reader imagine and feel what is being described.

✓ Adverb

- **Definition:** A word that describes how, when, where, or how often something happens.
- **Examples:**
 - *Quickly* (how)
 - *Yesterday* (when)
 - *Everywhere* (where)
- **Effect:** Gives more detail about the verb or action.

✓ Simile

- **Definition:** A comparison using "like" or "as".
- **Examples:**
 - "As brave as a lion."
 - "Her hair shone like gold."
 - "He moved as fast as lightning."
- **Effect:** Creates clear images or emotions in the reader's mind.

✓ Metaphor

- **Definition:** A direct comparison that says something *is* something else.
- **Examples:**
 - "Time is a thief."
 - "He was a rock in the storm."
 - "The world is a stage."
- **Effect:** Makes the description stronger or more emotional.

✓ Personification

- **Definition:** Giving human qualities to non-human things.
- **Examples:**
 - "The wind whispered."
 - "The sun smiled down."
 - "The car groaned in pain."
- **Effect:** Creates emotion or personality in objects or nature.

✓ Alliteration

- **Definition:** Repeating the same sound at the beginning of nearby words.
- **Examples:**
 - "Peter Piper picked a peck of pickled peppers."
 - "Dark and dangerous days."
 - "Silly snakes slither silently."
- **Effect:** Creates rhythm, mood, or emphasis.

✓ Onomatopoeia

- **Definition:** Words that sound like what they mean.

- **Examples:**
 - *Bang, crash, buzz*
 - *Splash, whisper, roar*
 - *Tick-tock, sizzle, clap*
- **Effect:** Makes writing more lively and realistic.

✓ Repetition

- **Definition:** Saying the same word or phrase more than once.
- **Examples:**
 - "Alone, alone, alone."
 - "Never give up. Never give in."
 - "It was cold, cold, cold."
- **Effect:** Emphasises a feeling or idea.

✓ Anaphora

- **Definition:** Repeating words at the beginning of sentences or phrases.
- **Examples:**
 - "We will fight. We will win. We will rise."
 - "Every day, every night, in every way."
 - "I want peace. I want freedom. I want change."
- **Effect:** Creates rhythm, unity, and power in writing.

Structural Devices

✓ Juxtaposition

- **Definition:** Putting opposite ideas close together.
- **Examples:**
 - "The rich man gave nothing to the starving child."
 - "Light danced in the darkness."
 - "She smiled during the funeral."
- **Effect:** Highlights contrasts, creates surprise or strong emotion.

✓ Short Sentence

- **Definition:** A sentence with few words.
- **Examples:**
 - "I was shocked."
 - "He froze."
 - "It ended."
- **Effect:** Adds drama, speed, or tension.

✓ Long Sentence

- **Definition:** A sentence with many parts or details.
- **Examples:**
 - "She walked through the garden, breathing in the scent of roses, watching the bees dance between the flowers."
 - "He thought about the past, the present, and the unknown future that waited."
 - "They ran across the field, jumped over the fence, and disappeared into the trees."
- **Effect:** Builds description, pace, or suspense.

✓ Dialogue

- **Definition:** Direct speech between characters.
- **Examples:**
 - "'What are you doing here?' she asked."
 - "'It's too late now,' he whispered."
 - "'Don't leave me!' she cried."
- **Effect:** Brings characters to life, shows emotion and personality.

✓ Foreshadowing

- **Definition:** A clue or hint about what will happen later.
- **Examples:**
 - "The air felt strange, like something bad was about to happen."
 - "She paused at the door, not knowing it would be her last time there."
 - "The storm clouds gathered in the distance."
- **Effect:** Builds suspense and makes the reader curious.

✓ Cyclical Structure

- **Definition:** The text begins and ends in the same way or place.
- **Examples:**

- Starts and ends in the same setting: "It began in the quiet village... It ended in that same quiet village."
- Repeats the same line: "Nothing changed. Nothing ever would."
- Characters return to where they started: "He left home to find answers. In the end, he returned, unchanged."
- **Effect:** Creates a sense of completeness or reflection.

This section is here to help you understand **key words** and **techniques** that appear in Paper 2. **Don't worry if you don't remember them all at once** – we will remind you as we go through each question.

Question 1: Finding Information

What Is Question 1?

Question type: Multiple choice (choose 4 true statements from a list of 8)

Skills tested: Basic understanding of information in the text

Marks: 4 marks (1 mark per correct answer)

This question tests your ability to **find correct information** in a small section of one of the texts (usually Source A). You do not need to explain or write in full sentences.

Key verbs in question:

- Choose
- True
- Identify

Important to know:

- All answers are in the text
- Only 4 of the 8 statements are correct
- You must use the text exactly. Do NOT guess

Example (Simplified)

Text: "Ali packed his bag and left the quiet room. Outside, it was already dark."

Choose four statements that are true:

- A. Ali packed his bag. ✓
- B. Ali was with his friend. ✗
- C. It was daytime. ✗
- D. The room was quiet. ✓
- E. Ali stayed inside. ✗
- F. Ali went outside. ✓
- G. Ali forgot his bag. ✗
- H. It was dark outside. ✓

Correct Answers: A, D, F, H

ESL Vocabulary Support:

- Packed = put things in a bag
- Quiet = no noise
- Left = went out
- Outside = not inside
- Dark = not light

✓ How to Answer

Step-by-Step Method:

1. **Read the question carefully.** Look at which lines it is asking you to read.
2. **Skim the correct part of the text.** Highlight key details (names, actions, times).
3. **Read all 8 statements.**
4. **Match the correct statements** to what you find in the text.
5. **Double check:** Is it exactly what the text says?
6. **Shade or tick** the 4 correct answers on the exam paper.

ESL Focus Box:

- Be careful with **negatives**: "did not", "wasn't"
- Watch for **time clues**: day/night, before/after
- Match **verbs** exactly: past tense ("left") is not the same as present ("leaves")

✓ Practice Time

Short Text: "The teacher glared as she handed out the Maths exam. Many of the students felt nervous, as they had not prepared for it. Maria, on the other hand, was excited, as she was the

only student who had studied for the exam."

Choose four true statements:

- A. The teacher was smiling
- B. The students had an English exam
- C. The teacher gave the exam to the students
- D. The teacher was a female
- E. Maria had prepared for the exam
- F. The students were not ready for the exam
- G. Maria felt nervous
- H. Maria and her friend Jamie were excited

Correct Answers: C, D, E, F

Explanation:

- A. "The teacher glared" – this is the opposite of "smiling", so A is **false**
- B. "Maths exam" – the students had a Maths exam, not an English exam, so B is **false**
- C. "handed out" and "gave" mean the same thing, so C is **true**
- D. "...as she..." – this means the teacher is a woman, so D is **true**
- E. "Maria... was the only student who had studied" – so E is **true**
- F. "not prepared" and "not ready" mean the same thing, so F is **true**
- G. "Maria... was excited" – this is the opposite of "nervous", so G is **false**
- H. There is no mention of Maria's friend Jamie in the text, so H is **false**

Question 2: Summary of Differences or Similarities

✓ What Is Question 2?

Question type: Summary

Skills tested: Comparing content, summarising using own words

Marks: 8 marks

You must compare what is **similar or different** between Source A and Source B on a specific topic (e.g., school, weather, travel).

Key verbs in question:

- Summarise
- Differences / similarities

- Compare

Important to know:

- Use your own words
- Focus on ideas, not language
- Stay in the correct lines

Example (Simplified)

Question: Summarise the **differences** between the two writers' experiences at school.

Source A: "We had strict rules. Talking was not allowed."

Source B: "School was fun. We played games in class."

Sample Answer:

- "Source A shows school was strict, but Source B shows it was relaxed and fun."

How to Answer

Step-by-Step Method:

1. **Read the question.** Find the **topic** (e.g., school life).
2. **Skim** the correct lines in **both** texts. **Highlight** ideas.
3. Write **2–3 points** of **comparison**.
4. Use **your own words**.
5. **Connect** the ideas clearly using **linking words**.

Sentence Starters:

- "In Source A..., but in Source B..."
- "One difference is that..."
- "While Source A shows..., Source B shows..."

ESL Focus Box:

- Use linking words: but, while, however, on the other hand
- Use past tense for both sources
- Don't copy long sentences. Use short, simple phrases

✓ Practice Time

Question: What are the differences in the schools described by Text A and Text B?

Text A: "At my old school, we wore uniforms and walked in lines."

Text B: "In my new school, we wear casual clothes and move freely."

Model Answer:

"In Text A, the school was more controlling and strict, but in Text B, the school offers more freedom to students."

- This answer compares the differences in schools shown by Text A and Text B
- Linking word "but" is used to create contrast (showing differences) between the texts
- Sentence starters used to make our answer easy to follow for the examiner

Question 3: Language Analysis

✓ What Is Question 3?

Question type: Analysis of language

Skills tested: Explaining how language is used to describe, create effect, or influence

Marks: 12 marks

This question asks you to explain how the **writer uses words or phrases** to make something **interesting, emotional, or powerful**.

Key verbs in question:

- Analyse
- Describe
- Explain effect

What to focus on:

- Interesting vocabulary
- Imagery (similes, metaphors)

- *Word choice (verbs, adjectives)*
- *Feelings or mood*

Example (Simplified)

Question: How does the writer use language to describe the river?

Text: "The river screamed as it crashed over the rocks."

Sample Answer:

- "The writer uses the verb 'screamed' to show the river is loud and scary."
- "The verb 'crashed' makes the river feel strong and dangerous."

ESL Vocabulary Support:

- Screamed = loud, like shouting
- Crashed = hit hard
- Gentle = soft, quiet
- Violent = strong and dangerous

How to Answer

Step-by-Step Method:

1. Read the question and **find the correct lines**
2. Highlight **2-3 powerful words or phrases**
3. Think about the **meaning and feeling**
4. Explain **what the reader sees, feels, or imagines**
5. Use **short quotes**

Sentence Starters:

- "The writer uses the word/phrase... to show..."
- "This creates a feeling of..."
- "The phrase '___' makes the reader think of..."

ESL Focus Box:

- Always say what the word means + what it shows
- Don't just say "this is a metaphor". Say what it means

✓ Practice Time

Text: "The fog hugged the houses, making everything quiet and hidden."

Question: How does the writer use language to describe the fog?

Model Answer:

- "The writer uses 'hugged' to show the fog is close and surrounding."
- "The words 'quiet and hidden' create a mysterious feeling."

ESL Mistake Alert:

- Don't describe the story. Describe the **language** and **effect** of this language **on the reader**

Question 4: Comparing Viewpoints

✓ What Is Question 4?

Question type: Comparison of viewpoints and methods

Skills tested: Comparing writers' attitudes, ideas, and techniques

Marks: 16 marks

This question asks you to:

- Compare the **opinions** of both writers
- Explain how they show those opinions

Key verbs in question:

- Compare
- Attitudes / Viewpoints
- How the writers show

Example (Simplified)

Question: Compare how the writers convey their viewpoints about the beach.

Source A: "The beach was peaceful. I loved every moment."

Source B: "The beach was boring and full of rubbish."

Sample Answer:

- "Writer A enjoyed the beach and shows this with the verb 'loved'."
- "Writer B had a negative view and uses the adjective 'boring'."

ESL Vocabulary Support:

- Positive: happy, peaceful, exciting
- Negative: boring, dangerous, stressful
- Viewpoint = opinion

How to Answer

Step-by-Step Method:

1. Read the question. What is the topic? (e.g. the beach)
2. Find each writer's opinion
3. Highlight words/phrases that show their feelings
4. Compare their attitudes and the words they use
5. Use linking words to join ideas

Sentence Starters:

- "Writer A feels..., shown by the word..."
- "Writer B has a different view..."
- "While Writer A thinks..., Writer B believes..."

ESL Focus Box:

- Don't just say what the text is about. Say what the **writer thinks**
- Use comparing phrases: while, however, on the other hand

✔ Practice Time

Question: Compare how the writers feel about the people they met.

Text A: "I was amazed by the kindness of the locals."

Text B: "The people were rude and ignored me."

Model Answer:

- "Writer A felt happy and amazed. They use the word 'kindness'."
- "Writer B felt upset. The word 'rude' shows this."
- "They have opposite views."

ESL Mistake Alert:

- Don't describe only what happens. Focus on **feelings + language** used to show opinions